

Scott Barrett's 2026 Fantasy Football Draft Guide

 fantasypoints.com/nfl/articles/2026/scott-barretts-2026-fantasy-football-draft-guide

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Every offseason, I produce enough fantasy football content to rival *War and Peace*.

And the entire time, you've been asking for just one article in particular. This one.

How am I approaching 2026 drafts? Where are my rankings? Who are my top draft-day targets? Who are my ["Exodia"](#) players — the players I don't want to leave my draft without?

Here's the answer to all of that, and the one article you've waited all offseason to read.

This article and all references to ADP (Average Draft Position) will be continually updated throughout the remainder of the offseason. (Last Update: August 22)

1QB/2RB/2WR/1TE/1Flex with PPR scoring is assumed throughout for Sleeper, Yahoo!, and ESPN leagues. FFPC drafters and auction drafters should scroll all the way down to our FAQs section.

How to Leverage This Article To Win Your League

With a single email, I've helped multiple people who'd never played fantasy football before — people who didn't know what a cornerback was — not just win, but dominate their leagues.

Here's the exact email I sent to those people:

- 1) I've attached [my rankings](#). Print those out.
- 2) Since you're drafting on Yahoo!, I've also attached Yahoo!'s ADP. Print that out as well.
- 3) As players are drafted, cross off names from both lists. Physically cross them off with a pen.
- 4) When drafting, consult both lists. The first list (my rankings) ranks how good each player is. The second list tells you when you should expect those players to be drafted. If you only consult my list, you'll do alright, but try to look at both lists. If I have a guy really high, but he's a lot lower on Yahoo!, you should draft him later. That way, you get more value and give yourself an even bigger edge.
- 5) Load up on RBs and WRs early. Don't be afraid to draft bench RBs or WRs before drafting your first QB or TE. Draft a Kicker with your second-to-last pick, and a DEF with your last pick.

Once the season starts, be sure to read the Fantasy Points Waiver Wire article every week to determine who to add and who to drop. When setting your lineup, use our projections to determine who to start and who to bench. And that's about all it really takes.

In the vast majority of home or work leagues, that really is about all it takes. However, for the more advanced and competitive players out there (98% of you reading this), I'd urge you to take this a few steps further.

At a minimum, you should contrast these two lists before your draft (my rankings vs. your draft site's ADP). You can do that in Excel or manually. Find the biggest values (my rankings vs. ADP), circle them, and then **plan your draft around them**. But again, that's only the bare minimum approach. And throughout the remainder of this article, I'll be doing this for you.

But **what you should really do if you want to dominate your league**, crush your enemies, see them driven before you, and hear the lamentation of their women is to **come into your draft with a preset game plan**. You want to be running multiple mock drafts before your league has its draft. You're going to want to know exactly who is going to be available to you at every round in your draft. And then, you're going to want to tailor your strategy around the best values likely to be available to you at each pick.

What is the best strategy for me? It really depends on your league settings, league format, the competitiveness of your league, the site you're drafting on, and your draft slot. I highly encourage you to study this article and run multiple mock drafts from your draft slot if you

know it beforehand or from every draft slot if you don't. Always try to have a game plan in place before you draft.

NOTE: PAY SPECIAL ATTENTION TO YOUR LEAGUE'S SPECIFIC SCORING

SETTINGS. Sometimes a savvy — or outright dishonest — commissioner will sneak in a rule change they're hoping the rest of the league misses. An old friend was in a work league filled with casuals, except for the commissioner, who was an experienced high-stakes player. He kept every other rule and scoring setting the same as ESPN's default, but added an extra 0.50 fantasy points per carry and made it a superflex league. Of course, he drafted Lamar Jackson, Jayden Daniels, and Derrick Henry. Half the league didn't notice the rule change until Week 3. If you're aware of these rule tweaks, these are generally the easiest leagues to exploit. If you need help tailoring my rankings to your specific league settings, please don't hesitate to reach out on Discord... Another important setting to know is how many teams in your league make the playoffs. If 50% make it, go all-in on upside and second-half fantasy points. If only 33% make it, upside matters a bit less, and early-season points matter a bit more.

Before every draft, I spend at least 30 minutes devising my optimal draft strategy, envisioning my perfect draft and which players are likeliest to be available at each pick. Why? Because the optimal draft strategy is not one based on positions, but [one based on players](#). And that can change dramatically based on your draft slot.

I encourage you to build out your own perfect draft and variations of that draft where things go awry. It's important to always have contingency plans in place, as things do often go awry.

I promise you'll be glad you put in this extra work.

NOTE: Auction drafters actually have an easier time of things, thanks to [this tool](#), which does all of the hard work for you.

The Exodias

As any *Yu-Gi-Oh!* fan and gigantic nerd knows, once you assemble all five pieces of Exodia the Forbidden One, you automatically win your duel.

Or in fantasy football terms — if you draft these five players that I'm recommending, you will automatically win your league. Seriously, you can just log out of the draft after you've taken the fifth Exodia player, because you've basically already won your league. Congratulations!

The "Exodias" are "must-draft players," "circle-your-draft-sheet players," or "build-your-draft-around values." Most practically, they're players you don't want to leave your draft without. They carry immense league-winning upside and are typically mispriced by multiple rounds,

meaning the value is so good you could reach a round (or sometimes more) and still come out ahead. The only rule is — just to make things more difficult for myself — they can't be players going in Rounds 1-4 of your draft.



This year, the five Exodias are:

- WR Parker Washington
- WR Luther Burden
- WR Mike Evans
- RB David Montgomery
- RB Jonathon Brooks



These are the players I want in every draft, no matter what — the ones I'm building my 2026 drafts around.

But it was really hard to cap this list at only five Exodias; maybe the hardest it's been for me in seven years. Because, honestly, I'm seeing **a buttload** of value in 2026 drafts.

If you allowed me to go beyond five, or let me label certain "ADP pockets" as Exodias instead of individual players, I'd add:

- Malik Willis is your Exodia QB
- Tucker Kraft (ESPN) or George Kittle (Sleeper / Yahoo!) is your Exodia TE
- Terry McLaurin
- Josh Downs
- Chris Godwin on ESPN

- Nuance & more — Brock Bowers would be my Exodia TE in an 8-team league. Dak Prescott would be my Exodia QB in a 6-point-per-passing-touchdown league. Rhamondre Stevenson could be an Exodia RB if I took a Zero-RB approach and was drafting on ESPN. Derrick Henry might be an Exodia RB in a non-PPR league that awarded 0.25 fantasy points per carry. K.C. Concepcion is an Exodia in keeper leagues. Blah, blah, blah, etc. There's an absolute crap ton of nuance here, which is why you need to read the full guide and tailor it to your league settings.

There's an insane amount of value this year — I don't remember the last time so many players were in the running for an Exodia writeup, and I don't remember ADP being this bad in August.

ESPN ADP in particular is insanely exploitable. Mike Clay should be embarrassed! (I'm using ESPN "ADP" here, but ESPN "RK" is even worse — right now Mike Evans goes behind Matthew Golden, and David Montgomery goes one pick before Rico Dowdle.) Or maybe my old boss is just doing us a solid by letting us build such ridiculous juggernaut teams. Either way, if even one subscriber misses the playoffs in their ESPN league, I'll have no choice but to commit seppuku.

These are more or less my favorite 5-10 must-draft players across the three major platforms, but there are more names you'll need to know. My recommendation is to go old school: print my overall rankings, print out the ADP of whatever site your league is drafting on, grab a highlighter (or several, in different colors), and highlight every player named throughout this article. Also write yourself notes next to each so you remember exactly where to target them. And then you'll be fully equipped to dominate your draft to such a degree you'll leave your leaguemates looking like this:



Optimal Draft Strategy in 2026

What's the optimal strategy in 2026 drafts?

Every strategy can, should, and will work this year. If I'm doing my job right, you should be able to win your league even if you fell asleep after Round 8.

In a vacuum and as a general rule, you're probably going to want to draft at least two RBs by the end of Round 3. You're going to want to wait at the QB position. And you're going to want to load up on WRs in the middle rounds of your draft. Blah, blah, blah.

But again — every strategy will work. You should be able to win whether you start RB-RB or go full Zero-RB and don't take an RB until Round 5 (though I think the latter strategy is ill-advised). I typically caution against an early-round QB or TE, but if current ADP holds, that could actually be optimal given how much late-round value there is this year.

So feel comforted knowing you've got some wiggle room here. You have permission to be a homer and go after some players on your favorite team, or reach a bit too high on a defense because you're too lazy to stream it. Really, there's really no wrong answer this year.

*“Okay, yeah, yeah, yeah. But what ***exactly*** do you think is optimal?”*

In a vacuum and broadly speaking, I want...

- ...to go as cheap as possible at QB.

- ...at least two RBs in the first three rounds, and then David Montgomery and Jonathon Brooks later.
- ...to load up on WRs in the middle rounds, honing in on names like Terry McLaurin, Luther Burden, Mike Evans, Christian Watson, Parker Washington, Josh Downs, etc. as the most extreme values.
- ...to draft George Kittle (on Sleeper and Yahoo!) or Tucker Kraft (on ESPN) as my TE1.
- ...take a kicker and defense in the last two rounds of my draft, or not at all.

How to Use This Article to Win Your Auction League

I'll be fully transparent — I'm no auction expert, and honestly pretty inexperienced with the format. That said, many auction players have used this Draft Guide for years, dominating their leagues based on my ranks.

And, luckily, I have some very good friends who decided to do me a big favor:

Drew Davenport is unanimously considered the best auction expert in the game. He did us a huge favor by writing a full article detailing how he would use my Draft Guide to dominate every auction league draft he entered. Fantasy Points subscribers can read that article [here](#).

MattyB from our Discord created [this](#) super sick auction tool based around my auction values. It'll help you plot out your perfect draft, and you can even use it during your draft to identify who to target based on the money you've already allocated to various players and positions.

For anyone who isn't in an auction league, MattyB also asked that I share the following advice with you — "I think it's worth mentioning in your guide the No. 1 most productive thing you can do is lobby your league to switch to auctions. Since I became a subscriber, I dominate my home league every year."

BARRETT'S RANKINGS OVERALL 1-50

#	POS	PLAYER	TEAM	#	POS	PLAYER	TEAM
1	RB	JAHMYR GIBBS	DET	26	WR	GEORGE PICKENS	DAL
2	RB	BIJAN ROBINSON	ATL	27	WR	TEE HIGGINS	CIN
3	RB	CHRISTIAN MCCAFFREY	SF	28	WR	ZAY FLOWERS	BAL
4	WR	JA'MARR CHASE	CIN	29	TE	TREY MCBRIDE	ARI
5	WR	PUKA NACUA	LAR	30	RB	CAM SKATTEBO	NYG
6	WR	AMON-RA ST. BROWN	DET	31	RB	JEREMIAH LOVE	ARI
7	RB	JONATHAN TAYLOR	IND	32	WR	CHRIS OLAVE	NO
8	RB	JAMES COOK	BUF	33	RB	DAVID MONTGOMERY	HOU
9	WR	JAXON SMITH-NJIGBA	SEA	34	WR	DEVONTA SMITH	PHI
10	RB	DE'VON ACHANE	MIA	35	WR	JAYLEN WADDLE	DEN
11	RB	CHASE BROWN	CIN	36	WR	LUTHER BURDEN III	CHI
12	RB	ASHTON JEANTY	LV	37	WR	TERRY MCLAURIN	WAS
13	RB	KENNETH WALKER III	KC	38	WR	MIKE EVANS	SF
14	RB	SAQUON BARKLEY	PHI	39	WR	PARKER WASHINGTON	JAX
15	RB	DERRICK HENRY	BAL	40	WR	EMEKA EGBUKA	TB
16	RB	OMARION HAMPTON	LAC	41	QB	JOSH ALLEN	BUF
17	WR	DRAKE LONDON	ATL	42	WR	LADD MCCONKEY	LAC
18	WR	JUSTIN JEFFERSON	MIN	43	WR	GARRETT WILSON	NYJ
19	WR	CEEDEE LAMB	DAL	44	RB	JAVONTE WILLIAMS	DAL
20	RB	JOSH JACOBS	GB	45	RB	JADARIAN PRICE	SEA
21	TE	BROCK BOWERS	LV	46	RB	TRAVIS ETIENNE	NO
22	WR	MALIK NABERS	NYG	47	QB	LAMAR JACKSON	BAL
23	WR	NICO COLLINS	HOU	48	RB	KYREN WILLIAMS	LAR
24	WR	A.J. BROWN	NE	49	WR	DAVANTE ADAMS	LAR
25	RB	BREECE HALL	NYJ	50	WR	TETAIROA MCMILLAN	CAR

FANTASY **POINTS**

Print or download rankings [here](#).

For the first time, I'm releasing a full set of my overall rankings. Just know I did this reluctantly and against my better judgment. My concern is that if you follow these rankings too closely, it can end up doing you more harm than good. You **should** be drafting off of my overall

rankings for the first 2-4 rounds of your draft, but after that you need to be dynamic — every pick changes the context of the next (if you started Zero-RB, the more important RBs become later, if you already have Josh Allen, the rest of the QB sheet is dead to you, etc.).

And please, consult your draft site's ADP alongside this sheet. Don't reach too far on "my guys" if you don't have to.

I've also included recommended auction prices in my overall rankings. This is only meant to be a guideline. I DO NOT consider myself to be an auction expert. I only did this because 20 different people have asked for it.

Quarterback

Rankings

BARRETT'S RANKINGS TOP 20 QUARTERBACKS

#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER
1	JOSH ALLEN	BUF	1
2	LAMAR JACKSON	BAL	2
3	JAYDEN DANIELS	WAS	2
4	JALEN HURTS	PHI	2
5	DRAKE MAYE	NE	2
6	JAXSON DART	NYG	3
7	TREVOR LAWRENCE	JAX	3
8	JOE BURROW	CIN	3
9	DAK PRESCOTT	DAL	4
10	JUSTIN HERBERT	LAC	4
11	CALEB WILLIAMS	CHI	4
12	MALIK WILLIS	MIA	5
13	KYLER MURRAY	MIN	5
14	BROCK PURDY	SF	5
15	BO NIX	DEN	6
16	PATRICK MAHOMES	KC	6
17	MATTHEW STAFFORD	LAR	6
18	BAKER MAYFIELD	TB	6
19	JARED GOFF	DET	7
20	JORDAN LOVE	GB	7

FANTASY**POINTS**

Print or download rankings [here](#).

Average Draft Position

QB PLATFORM ADP SLEEPER, YAHOO & ESPN POSITION ADP — 2026				
AVG	PLAYER	SLEEPER	YAHOO	ESPN
1	 Josh Allen	1	1	1
2	 Lamar Jackson	2	2	3
3	 Drake Maye	3	3	4
4	 Jayden Daniels	5	4	2
5	 Joe Burrow	4	5	6
6	 Jalen Hurts	6	6	5
7	 Dak Prescott	8	10	9
8	 Caleb Williams	7	7	13
9	 Trevor Lawrence	11	9	8
10	 Jaxson Dart	9	13	7
11	 Justin Herbert	10	8	14
12	 Brock Purdy	14	11	11
13	 Bo Nix	15	12	10
14	 Matthew Stafford	12	15	12
15	 Patrick Mahomes	13	16	15
16	 Kyler Murray	19	14	16
17	 Jared Goff	16	17	18
18	 Baker Mayfield	17	20	20
19	 Tyler Shough	20	21	17
20	 Jordan Love	18	19	22
21	 Malik Willis	24	18	21
22	 Daniel Jones	26	22	19

FANTASYPOINTS

QB Strategy / Targets

If I were drafting 100 teams (all 1QB, 4-point passing TD leagues), here are the only approaches I'd ever take:

- **Best Early-to-Mid-Round Value: Jalen Hurts** — Paying up for **Josh Allen** is fine in an 8- or 10-team league. But if you can wait a little, **Jalen Hurts** is the clear best value among the early-round QBs, going as QB6 on every major site. He's your Exodia QB in 8-team leagues, and close to it in 10-team leagues. That said, I'm probably never drafting Hurts in 12-team leagues.
- **Best Later-Round Value: Jaxson Dart & Trevor Lawrence** — After spending much of the offseason debating Jaxson Dart and Trevor Lawrence, ADP made it easy: Jaxson Dart (my QB6) is an obscene value on Yahoo! (ADP: QB13). But Trevor Lawrence (my QB7) is the better value on Sleeper (QB11). And then on ESPN, I'd rather full-on punt and wait until the double-digit rounds to take a QB.
- **Best Punt QB: Malik Willis > Kyler Murray** — At any given point in my draft, I never feel pressured into taking a QB because the late-round value is so immense with **Malik Willis** (preferred), **Kyler Murray**, or better yet, both QBs paired together. Willis, for instance, is being drafted as the QB18-QB25, but feels exactly like my 2022 Exodia Justin Fields. (Remember, that year, the 3-12 Bears had the worst WR corps in the league and finished bottom-10 in scoring, although Fields still averaged 24.9 FPG over his last 10 games.) Because of how much Willis runs, it's hard to envision him putting up anything less than low-end QB1 numbers even if he stinks. But if he's any good or even just average, he could be a highest-end QB1. And, honestly, Brett and I both think he's a much better talent than Justin Fields ever was.

Everyone gets most excited about my Exodia QB every year, but, truthfully, the QB position just doesn't really matter all that much for fantasy.

The waiver-wire-based floor (and ceiling) at the position is massive. It might be hard to stomach, and you might struggle through the first four weeks of the season. But you can still very easily end up with mid-to-low-end QB1 production *even if you didn't select a single QB in your draft*. [You can do that just by week-to-week streaming alone](#), with added upside should one of the QBs you pick up turn out to be 2025 Matthew Stafford (QB3 by fantasy points per start), 2024 Baker Mayfield (QB4), 2023 Joe Flacco (QB3), 2023 Jake Browning (QB6), etc.

Although QB isn't that impactful, and you can win with any approach, there can still only be one Exodia QB. And this year that's **Malik Willis**, mostly just because of how cheap he is. I really like Jalen Hurts, Jaxson Dart, and Trevor Lawrence, but they're all being drafted next to RBs and WRs I **love.** And those positions matter so much more in terms of whether or not you win or lose your fantasy league than a QB.

That being said....

If you allowed me to be a bit more nuanced, this year's true Exodia QB would actually be a combination of the following QBs:

- Trevor Lawrence (ADP: QB11) & Malik Willis (ADP: QB24) on Sleeper
- Jaxson Dart (ADP: QB13) & Malik Willis (ADP: QB18) on Yahoo!
- Jaxson Dart (ADP: QB12) & Malik Willis (ADP: QB21) on FFPC
- Malik Willis (ADP: QB21) & Kyler Murray (ADP: QB16) on ESPN

6-point per passing touchdown leagues

In 6-point leagues, **DO NOT** draft off my rankings — they're built to exploit the Konami Code; the cheat code baked into hyper-mobile QBs that hits much harder in 4-point leagues.

If you're in a 6-point-per-passing-touchdown league, disregard all of the above (including my rankings) and just draft Dak Prescott (ADP: QB9-10, Rounds 7-9) as your Exodia QB.

If you miss out on Prescott, pivot to Matthew Stafford (ADP: QB13-17).

Superflex leagues

In Superflex leagues, [the math changes dramatically](#), and QBs now become the most important position in fantasy. But even though that's true, I still prefer chasing value and taking more of a late-round QB approach in my superflex drafts. (Because we've historically had so much success nailing all the right late-round QB gems.)

Like in 6-point leagues, largely disregard my rankings; they're built for 1QB leagues where upside is everything, while Superflex rewards floor and median a bit more.

I almost always leave my 2026 Superflex drafts with exactly three QBs: at least one from the Jaxson Dart/Trevor Lawrence/Dak Prescott tier, and at least one of Malik Willis and Kyler Murray. For some more site-specific values, Justin Herbert is a steal on ESPN (ADP: QB15), as is Brock Purdy on Yahoo! (ADP: QB16). Baker Mayfield (ADP: QB19-25) is the latest I'd want to draft my QB3. Those seven names are basically my whole pool in superflex leagues. I won't fault you for a Josh Allen or a Jalen Hurts, but I generally like my teams better when I've passed on the expensive QBs.

Running Back

Rankings

BARRETT'S RANKINGS

TOP 40 RUNNING BACKS

#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER	#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER
1	JAHMYR GIBBS	DET	1	21	KYREN WILLIAMS	LAR	6
2	BIJAN ROBINSON	ATL	1	22	D'ANDRE SWIFT	CHI	6
3	C. MCCAFFREY	SF	2	23	BHAYSHUL TUTEN	JAX	6
4	JONATHAN TAYLOR	IND	3	24	QUINSHON JUDKINS	CLE	6
5	JAMES COOK	BUF	3	25	JONATHON BROOKS	CAR	7
6	DE'VON ACHANE	MIA	3	26	BUCKY IRVING	TB	7
7	CHASE BROWN	CIN	3	27	TONY POLLARD	TEN	7
8	ASHTON JEANTY	LV	3	28	R. STEVENSON	NE	7
9	KENNETH WALKER III	KC	3	29	T. HENDERSON	NE	7
10	SAQUON BARKLEY	PHI	3	30	J. CROSKEY-MERRITT	WAS	8
11	DERRICK HENRY	BAL	3	31	J.K. DOBBINS	DEN	8
12	OMARION HAMPTON	LAC	3	32	CHUBA HUBBARD	CAR	8
13	JOSH JACOBS	GB	4	33	RICO DOWDLE	PIT	8
14	BREECE HALL	NYJ	5	34	AARON JONES	MIN	8
15	CAM SKATTEBO	NYG	5	35	BLAKE CORUM	LAR	9
16	DAVID MONTGOMERY	HOU	5	36	KENNY GAINWELL	TB	9
17	JEREMIAH LOVE	ARI	5	37	RJ HARVEY	DEN	9
18	JAVONTE WILLIAMS	DAL	5	38	RACHAAD WHITE	WAS	9
19	JADARIAN PRICE	SEA	6	39	JAYLEN WARREN	PIT	9
20	TRAVIS ETIENNE	NO	6				

FANTASY**POINTS**

Print or download rankings [here](#).

Average Draft Position

RB PLATFORM ADP				
SLEEPER, YAHOO & ESPN POSITION ADP — 2026				
AVG	PLAYER	SLEEPER	YAHOO	ESPN
1	Jahmyr Gibbs	1	1	1
2	Bijan Robinson	2	2	2
3	Christian McCaffrey	3	3	3
4	Jonathan Taylor	4	4	4
5	James Cook III	5	5	6
6	Saquon Barkley	8	6	8
7	De'Von Achane	6	10	7
8	Ashton Jeanty	7	8	10
9	Kenneth Walker III	11	7	9
10	Derrick Henry	12	12	5
11	Chase Brown	10	9	13
12	Omarion Hampton	9	11	14
13	Jeremiyah Love	13	13	11
14	Breece Hall	16	14	12
15	Josh Jacobs	15	17	15
16	Kyren Williams	14	15	18
17	Javonte Williams	17	16	16
18	Travis Etienne Jr.	20	19	17
19	Cam Skattebo	19	20	20
20	Quinshon Judkins	23	22	19
21	Bucky Irving	18	24	22
22	D'Andre Swift	24	18	23
23	David Montgomery	21	21	24
24	Bhayshul Tuten	25	23	21
25	TreVeyon Henderson	22	25	26
26	Jadarian Price	26	26	25
27	Rhamondre Stevenson	30	27	27
28	Jaylen Warren	27	28	30
29	Tony Pollard	31	29	29
30	Rico Dowdle	32	32	28
31	J.K. Dobbins	33	31	32
32	Chuba Hubbard	28	35	35
33	Jonathon Brooks	40	30	31
34	Jacory Croskey-Merritt	36	33	33
35	Kyle Monangai	34	38	34
36	Blake Corum	35	34	38
37	RJ Harvey	29	37	43
38	Jordan Mason	39	36	37

RB Strategy / Targets

If I were drafting 100 teams on ESPN and Yahoo!, about 85% would look exactly like this: 2-3 RBs by the end of Round 3, David Montgomery, Jonathon Brooks, then no other RBs until the last two rounds.

Sometimes, it's really just that simple.

Long-time readers will know that RB is [the most important position in fantasy](#), and league-winning RBs typically only reside in Rounds 1-3. This year in particular — with so much obscene WR value in the middle and later rounds of your draft — it really feels like you're putting yourself at a competitive disadvantage if you're not starting your draft with an RB-RB or RB-WR-RB approach. And such an approach should be mandatory in standard (non-PPR) leagues.

For Rounds 1-3, just draft off of my overall rankings. And if you do that, this will probably lead you towards an RB-RB or RB-WR-RB start anyway.

Josh Jacobs looks fairly Exodia-ish if you're contrasting my ranking of him (RB13) with his ADP on any site (as low as RB17 on Yahoo! and RB18 on FFPC). I really like the value and am frequently drafting him, but he's not an official Exodia because I'm so often starting drafts RB-RB (two Tier 1-3 backs) that I don't need him in Round 3 — I'd rather take a WR and grab David Montgomery and Jonathon Brooks later. But if you have fewer than two RBs and the Tier 1-3 backs are already gone, Jacobs is a phenomenal pick. He was fantasy's RB4 by XFP/G (17.7) and RB6 by FPG (19.7) through the first 10 weeks of the season, before a Week 11 knee injury. I'm not buying into the suspension-risk narrative at all. **(UPDATED 8/19)**

Who are my must-draft RBs in the middle and later rounds of your draft?

- **Exodia RB1: David Montgomery** — Per sources, expect Montgomery's workload to be at least as good as it was for Joe Mixon in 2024, when he averaged 19.3 carries, 3.7 targets, and 18.9 FPG (~RB5) across his 12 full games. Montgomery feels like one of the safest picks on the board, nearly guaranteed to beat his RB23-25 ADP, while offering legitimate low-end RB1 upside or better. He's an Exodia — just don't take him ahead of Cam Skattebo, who I have ranked higher. But since Montgomery is typically a full round cheaper, he's the RB I'll have on the vast majority of my rosters, especially on ESPN and Yahoo!, though less frequently on Sleeper... On Sleeper, the rule becomes "draft at least one of **Cam Skattebo**, David Montgomery, or **Jadarian Price**." Montgomery is more expensive (Round 5) and Skattebo much cheaper on Sleeper than anywhere else. Since I have Skattebo ranked higher and he typically goes only 4-8 picks earlier, I'll probably end up with more Skattebo than Montgomery on Sleeper (also true on FFPC, where the gap is about the same). But if you miss out on Skattebo/Montgomery on Sleeper, don't feel too bad, because Jadarian Price is even more badly mispriced — typically Round 7 as the ADP RB29.

- **Exodia RB2: Jadarian Price or Jonathon Brooks** — That's right, we're doing it again. Your failed 2024 Exodia RB is Exodia once more. I expect his ADP to keep climbing through the summer, but as it stands, he's an absolute must-draft at his current Round 10-12 price, and I have no problem reaching an extra round or two if I feel I need to. Just one word of caution — we're drafting Brooks for what he can do in the second half of the season, not the first, so please be patient. (And with that in mind, know he does lose Exodia status in 8-team or very shallow leagues.) **UPDATE (August 18th)** — Brooks' ADP is skyrocketing; as high as RB30 on Yahoo! That still means he's a tremendous value, and the last RB I'm actually excited to take. But in case his price keeps climbing, just make sure you're never taking him ahead of **Jadarian Price**. Price would become the true Exodia RB2 if he's ever cheaper than Brooks. And if you ever miss out on both, pivot to Tony Pollard, who goes as high as RB29 on any site. (Although Pollard is only necessary if you don't feel great about your RBs at that point.)

As a general rule of thumb, always prioritize the Exodia RBs over the Exodia WRs and TEs. Montgomery and Brooks are typically the only super-extreme values at the RB position, while WR has many more names to like.

But what if you ignored my advice and took a Zero-RB approach in your draft? What if one of your league mates is a Fantasy Points subscriber and sniped you on Montgomery and Brooks? Don't worry! We've always got a backup plan:

If you took a Zero-RB approach, you're going to want to draft **Tony Pollard** or **Rhamondre Stevenson**. Neither offers real league-winning upside, but both are strong values who carry an extremely high floor — well suited for a Zero-RB roster that might be more in need of guaranteed points. Stevenson's the better value on ESPN (Round 9), Pollard wins everywhere else (Round 8). If you missed out, or needed more names, I also really like **Jacory Croskey-Merritt's** (Round 10, ESPN) upside relative to the price.

But for the most part, Brooks is almost always the last RB I'm taking. The only exception is a potential dart-throw RB in the last 1-2 rounds of my draft. If I take an RB there, it's probably (in order): James Conner, Tank Bigsby, Isiah Pacheco, or Ray Davis. And even then, there's a very good chance I'm dropping one of these handcuff-type RBs for a kicker or defense before Week 1.

TLDR / CTRL+F: Exodia — Draft 2-3 RBs by the end of Round 3, draft David Montgomery, draft Jonathon Brooks, don't take any other RBs until the last two rounds of the draft. There's maybe a little bit more nuance here if you're drafting on Sleeper or FFPC, instead of ESPN or Yahoo!, but this is more or less what I'm doing 85% of the time.

Wide Receiver

Rankings

BARRETT'S RANKINGS TOP 40 WIDE RECEIVERS

#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER	#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER
1	JAMARR CHASE	CIN	1	21	EMEKA EGBUKA	TB	6
2	PUKA NACUA	LAR	1	22	LADD MCCONKEY	LAC	6
3	AMON-RA ST. BROWN	DET	2	23	GARRETT WILSON	NYJ	6
4	JAXON SMITH-NJIGBA	SEA	3	24	DAVANTE ADAMS	LAR	6
5	DRAKE LONDON	ATL	3	25	TETAIROA MCMILLAN	CAR	7
6	JUSTIN JEFFERSON	MIN	3	26	CHRISTIAN WATSON	GB	7
7	CEEDEE LAMB	DAL	3	27	RASHEE RICE	KC	7
8	MALIK NABERS	NYG	4	28	DJ MOORE	BUF	8
9	NICO COLLINS	HOU	4	29	JAMESON WILLIAMS	DET	8
10	A.J. BROWN	NE	4	30	CARNELL TATE	TEN	8
11	GEORGE PICKENS	DAL	4	31	BRIAN THOMAS JR.	JAX	8
12	TEE HIGGINS	CIN	5	32	CHRIS GODWIN JR.	TB	9
13	ZAY FLOWERS	BAL	5	33	JOSH DOWNS	IND	9
14	CHRIS OLAVE	NO	5	34	COURTLAND SUTTON	DEN	9
15	DEVONTA SMITH	PHI	5	35	MICHAEL WILSON	ARI	9
16	JAYLEN WADDLE	DEN	5	36	QUENTIN JOHNSTON	LAC	9
17	LUTHER BURDEN III	CHI	5	37	ROME ODUNZE	CHI	10
18	TERRY MCLAURIN	WAS	5	38	KC CONCEPCION	CLE	10
19	MIKE EVANS	SF	6	39	DE'ZHAUN STRIBLING	SF	11
20	P. WASHINGTON	JAX	6	40	MICHAEL PITTMAN	PIT	10

FANTASY**POINTS**

Print or download rankings [here](#).

Average Draft Position

WR PLATFORM ADP				
SLEEPER, YAHOO & ESPN POSITION ADP — 2026				
AVG	PLAYER	SLEEPER	YAHOO	ESPN
1	Ja'Marr Chase	1	1	1
2	Puka Nacua	2	2	2
3	Jaxon Smith-Njigba	3	4	3
4	Amon-Ra St. Brown	4	3	4
5	CeeDee Lamb	5	5	5
6	Justin Jefferson	6	6	6
7	Drake London	7	7	7
8	Nico Collins	10	8	9
9	A.J. Brown	8	10	10
10	George Pickens	9	9	13
11	Malik Nabers	12	11	12
12	Rashee Rice	11	17	8
13	Chris Olave	13	16	11
14	DeVonta Smith	16	12	19
15	Tee Higgins	14	13	22
16	Emeka Egbuka	18	18	15
17	Tetairoa McMillan	15	19	17
18	Zay Flowers	19	14	18
19	Garrett Wilson	20	21	16
20	Ladd McConkey	17	20	23
21	Jaylen Waddle	21	15	25
22	Davante Adams	23	28	14
23	Terry McLaurin	24	22	21
24	Luther Burden III	22	23	27
25	Rome Odunze	29	25	20
26	Jameson Williams	25	27	24
27	DJ Moore	26	24	26
28	Mike Evans	27	29	33
29	Carnell Tate	28	33	29
30	Christian Watson	30	26	34
31	Marvin Harrison Jr.	33	31	32
32	DK Metcalf	32	35	31
33	Parker Washington	35	30	35
34	Brian Thomas Jr.	31	32	37
35	Courtland Sutton	36	44	28
36	Alec Pierce	40	41	30
37	Michael Wilson	37	39	39
38	Michael Pittman Jr.	42	43	36
39	Jordan Addison	43	42	40
40	Quentin Johnston	44	40	42
41	Chris Godwin Jr.	39	37	53
42	Josh Downs	46	36	48
43	Jakobi Meyers	41	50	41
44	Jordyn Tyson	34	34	65
45	Makai Lemon	38	46	50

WR Strategy / Targets

I have one Exodia QB, one Exodia TE, and only two Exodia RBs. At WR, I could've had 10.

There's just an absolutely obscene number of mispriced WRs in the middle-to-late rounds this year — a big reason we want at least two RBs by the end of Round 3.

I'm rarely drafting a WR in Round 1 unless it's Ja'Marr Chase or Puka Nacua. Round 2 is usually RB for me too, though I'll have some Drake London exposure — especially in leagues you start 3WRs plus a flex.

I always want at least two RBs by the end of Round 3. I always want at least two and ideally three WRs by the end of Round 5.

Really, just try to follow along with my overall rankings. If you do that, you're going to end up with two of: **Malik Nabers** (my WR8, going WR12 on ESPN and Sleeper), **Tee Higgins** (my WR13, going WR22 on ESPN), **Zay Flowers** (my WR13, going WR19 on Sleeper), **Chris Olave** (my WR13, going WR16 on Yahoo!), **DeVonta Smith** (my WR15, going WR19 on ESPN), and **Jaylen Waddle** (my WR16, going WR25 on ESPN).

After that, there are clear targets throughout each range of your draft. You won't be able to draft all of them, and you wouldn't want to. Just make sure you're keeping a close eye on each of the following names:

- **Luther Burden** is an insane value ESPN (ADP: WR27), and still a very strong value everywhere else (WR22-24).
- **Terry McLaurin** is damn close to Exodia status now, as his ADP has taken a hit in the wake of the Stefon Diggs signing. He's my WR17, but goes WR21-24 across all major sites.
- The disrespect on **Mike Evans** is astounding, disturbing, and reminiscent of 2023 Keenan Allen (a former Exodia that worked out great for us). He's going WR27-33 on every major site although he ranks as my WR19... **Christian Watson** is another extreme value, ranking as my WR25, though he goes as late as WR30 on Sleeper and WR34 on ESPN. The only issue: he goes very close to Evans across all major sites, so if you're ever forced to pick between them, make sure you prioritize Evans.
- **Draft Parker Washington (Rounds 8-9), or else we're not friends anymore** — Washington might be the single most mispriced player at any position. He is the Exodia WR to end all Exodia WRs. And Washington (my WR20) is such a strong value (being drafted as the WR39-40 on all major sites) that you can reach more than a full round and still come away a winner. So, after your draft ends, I want you to tell me: Are we still friends? **UPDATE (8/18)** — Although Washington's ADP continues to climb (now as high as WR30 on Yahoo!, but WR35 everywhere else), it's not climbing anywhere close to where I have him ranked. So, he still looks like the single-most mispriced player in drafts to me.

In the later rounds you'll find a few more priority targets. Here are the best values based on my rankings:

- **Chris Godwin (my WR32)** is an Exodia on ESPN, where he goes WR53.
- **Josh Downs (my WR33)** is an Exodia on Sleeper (ADP: WR46) and ESPN (ADP: WR48). Yes, I'm aware Keenan Allen has recently signed with the Colts.
- Rookies **K.C. Concepcion (my WR38)** and **De'Zhaun Stribling (my WR39)** are two terrific late-round options if you can get them anywhere near their current ADP — WR46-57 for Concepcion and WR49-62 for Stribling. The problem is, you probably won't be able to, as these are two of the biggest hype darlings and offseason risers. If you're in a shallow league, don't lose any sleep if you missed out — there's a very good chance both WRs are available on waivers in Week 4. (Although the odds are a little better for Concepcion that he's an immediate Week 1 contributor.) But if you're in a keeper league or in an especially deep league (where the waiver wire is typically more barren), I'd really want to leave my draft with at least one of them. If you drafted Mike Evans or George Kittle as I told you to and are worried about them staying healthy all year, feel free to prioritize Stribling in your drafts. Just know that if you're drafting him, you're doing so more for what he can do in the second half of the season than the first.

Apologies for giving you so many names! I really tried to keep this as short as possible — ADP is just THAT bad at WR this year.

But you don't want all of these guys. In a typical 10-team ESPN league (9 starters, 7 bench, 16 rounds), you want to leave your draft with 4-5 RBs, 1-2 QBs, 1-2 TEs, 0-1 Ks, 0-1 DSTs, and 6-8 WRs.

But the main takeaway should be clear — there's a ton of value at the WR position in the middle and late rounds of your draft. This is why I keep advising you to go RB-heavy at the start of your draft. If you do that, and draft more of these WRs (that were explicitly mentioned by name) than any of your opponents, you're probably going to win your league.

BARRETT'S RANKINGS

TOP 20 TIGHT ENDS

#	PLAYER	TEAM	TIER
1	BROCK BOWERS	LV	1
2	TREY MCBRIDE	ARI	1
3	COLSTON LOVELAND	CHI	2
4	TYLER WARREN	IND	2
5	SAM LAPORTA	DET	2
6	HAROLD FANNIN JR.	CLE	3
7	TUCKER KRAFT	GB	3
8	GEORGE KITTLE	SF	3
9	KYLE PITTS	ATL	4
10	DALLAS GOEDERT	PHI	4
11	ISAIAH LIKELY	NYG	4
12	DALTON KINCAID	BUF	4
13	MARK ANDREWS	BAL	4
14	TRAVIS KELCE	KC	4
15	TERRANCE FERGUSON	LAR	5
16	JAKE FERGUSON	DAL	5
17	JUWAN JOHNSON	NO	6
18	ORONDE GADSDEN II	LAC	6
19	BRENTON STRANGE	JAX	6
20	CHIG OKONKWO	WAS	6

FANTASY**POINTS**

Print or download rankings [here](#).

Average Draft Position

TE PLATFORM ADP

SLEEPER, YAHOO & ESPN POSITION ADP — 2026

AVG	PLAYER	SLEEPER	YAHOO	ESPN
1	 Trey McBride	1	1	1
2	 Brock Bowers	2	1	2
3	 Colston Loveland	3	3	3
4	 Tyler Warren	4	4	4
5	 Sam LaPorta	5	6	6
6	 Tucker Kraft	6	5	8
7	 Kyle Pitts Sr.	8	8	5
8	 Harold Fannin Jr.	7	7	7
9	 George Kittle	9	9	9
10	 Travis Kelce	11	11	11
11	 Dalton Kincaid	10	10	14
12	 Dallas Goedert	15	12	10
13	 Jake Ferguson	12	15	13
14	 Mark Andrews	16	14	12
15	 Isaiah Likely	14	13	15
16	 Hunter Henry	17	19	16
17	 Kenyon Sadiq	18	22	17
18	 Brenton Strange	19	18	20
19	 T.J. Hockenson	20	20	19
20	 Juwan Johnson	23	17	21

FANTASY POINTS

TE Strategy / Targets

If I were drafting 100 teams, these are still just about the only approaches I'd ever take:

- **Early-Round TE: Brock Bowers > Trey McBride** — Bowers is an Exodia in 8-team leagues and probably also 10-team leagues. (The same can be said for McBride as a backup plan, if you missed out on Bowers.) But I'm almost never drafting Bowers or McBride in 12-team leagues. The opportunity cost against a similarly priced RB or WR is just too steep for a onesie position.
- **Mid-Round TE: Sam LaPorta** — I was shocked when I saw LaPorta (my TE5) was going in Round 7 on all sites, being drafted as the TE7 or TE8. That's good value for sure, but I think there are still too many RB/WRs I like in that range, and I don't think LaPorta provides *that* much more value over a Tucker Kraft or George Kittle who will be going multiple rounds later.
- **Late-Round TE: Tucker Kraft / George Kittle** — Kraft and Kittle are neck-and-neck in my rankings, but ADP makes it easy on us. Kraft is the preferred pick on ESPN, going in Round 8 as the ADP TE9. And then Kittle is the preferred pick everywhere else, going in Rounds 8-10 as the TE9 on Yahoo! and Sleeper. If drafting either TE, I'll almost always want to be pairing them with either Goedert or Likely.
- **Full-On Punt: Dallas Goedert > Isaiah Likely** — I honestly can't remember the last time I liked the high-end TE2 range in drafts this much. Oh, wait! Yes, I can. It was 2019 when I couldn't decide between Mark Andrews and Darren Waller as my Exodia TE. There's just an incredibly underrated ceiling-to-floor ratio here. I prefer Goedert (ADP: TE10-15), then Likely (ADP: TE13-17), although it's close. (And I also don't mind Dalton Kincaid or Mark Andrews if you miss out.) Both pair exceptionally well with a Kraft/Kittle pick if you were worried about their health. (Likely could get fed in the first month of the season if Malik Nabers is less than 100%. And Goedert has the position's best early-season strength of schedule.)

I think you will like your teams the most if you end up going the Kraft / Kittle route. For clarity, that's Kraft on ESPN and Kittle on Yahoo! and Sleeper. FFPC leagues are a lot more complicated (with their TE Premium scoring), so I'll save that for the FAQs section.

TLDR / CTRL+F: Exodia — Tucker Kraft on ESPN, George Kittle everywhere else as your TE1. Ideally, paired with Dallas Goedert or Isaiah Likely as your TE2.

The only caveat is that you need to know what you're getting yourself into if you draft Kraft or Kittle. There's a very real chance neither TE returns to 100% full effectiveness until October. So, I need you to be patient. I need you to know that's a very real possibility. And remember not to sell low after a sluggish September. Beyond that, there's a very real chance Kittle misses San Francisco's Week 1 game in Australia, although I believe he almost assuredly returns for Week 2. Ultimately, I don't think this

requires you to draft a TE2, but because there's so much good value late (in the Likely-Goedert-Kincaid-Andrews tier), it's probably a smart idea to do so. These are real concerns you need to be aware of, but not anything I find too distasteful. An 80% Kittle will still outscore a few of the TEs going ahead of him. And some combination of starting Isaiah Likely in the first half of the year and George Kittle in the second half probably outscores even more TEs than that.

I typically never draft a second TE, but this year would be the exception. If you take Kraft or Kittle, grab one of the preferred punts (ideally Likely or Goedert) — and if both hit, trade one away at a profit.

Just try not to reach, and don't ever feel forced into a pick. Remember, the TE position just doesn't really matter a whole lot in terms of whether or not you're going to make it to your league's championship. It's a devalued position. And you can win with any of the above approaches, so feel free to pick your favorite.

Kicker / Defense

Yeah...

In most leagues, I'm typically not even drafting a kicker or a defense. Instead, I'll be drafting high-upside flex-eligible players. And then, right before Week 1, I'll drop the two worst players on my team, and pick up whichever K and DEF I like best on waivers.

If that isn't an option, or if I'm drafting particularly late in the offseason, I'll always draft a kicker and then a defense (in that order) with my last two picks.

Who am I taking? It really doesn't matter. Usually, whichever K ranks highest in our projections (or ADP) and whichever DEF has the best Week 1 matchup.

ADP is generally really bad at predicting who the top kickers and defenses are going to be in a given season. K and DEF are also extremely deep, very replaceable, and not worth much at all in terms of winning your league.

In real terms, you have a much better chance at returning top-three production by streaming DEFs than you do of drafting the first DEF off the board. All of this is explained in more detail [here](#). (TLDR: The last time I wrote a "Streaming Defenses" column, I — *very easily* — returned top-three production.)

If you put a gun to my head and demanded I give you a name, I'd say **Jake Bates is the Exodia Kicker**, and the **Jacksonville Jaguars are the Exodia DST**.

Frequently Asked Questions

I'll be adding to this list as questions roll in. If you ever want to ask me a question or debate my rankings, please tag me in our subscriber Discord (link) in the #nfl-standard channel.

Q: “When is the best time to schedule my draft?”

As soon as possible. Every year, without fail, all of “my guys” steadily move up in ADP after this article drops. It’s not uncommon for Exodias to appreciate multiple rounds in cost by the end of the summer.

Q: “What is the best platform to host my online draft and league?”

ESPN leagues. Because their ADP is so embarrassingly soft this year, you can build some ridiculous juggernaut teams even if 90% of your league knows what they’re doing.

Q: “What is your favorite spot to draft?”

The 1.01, then the 1.02. Those are far and away the best spots. After that, probably the 1.05, 1.04, and 1.03, in that order.

Q: “Why do you have Player X so high and Player Z so low?”

Here is some of my reasoning on why I have these guys ranked where I do:

- QB Rankings
- RB Rankings
- WR Rankings (ETA: 8/25)
- TE Rankings

Q: “If I drafted Running Back X, do I need to draft his handcuff?”

Handcuffs are usually a wasted pick and dead roster weight when you'd rather be churning the waiver wire for a potential league-winner. Even a handcuff that hits comes at the expense of the RB you drafted earlier — raising your floor at the cost of ceiling (and median). So if I'm ever drafting a handcuff, it's always in the last two rounds (unless I'm drafting in a deep format like FFPC), and always someone else's early-round RB's handcuff, never my own.

Q: “My league drafts on Yahoo!, and I noticed they tend to follow Yahoo!’s default XRank more so than ADP. How would that influence your draft strategy?”

This definitely makes things trickier.

You're going to have to reach a little more if you want to walk away with one of these Exodias: Luther Burden (going 12 picks earlier by XRank), Mike Evans (9 picks earlier), Christian Watson (17 picks earlier), Parker Washington (26 picks earlier), and Josh Downs (22 picks earlier).

I'll be honest. This stinks. We're definitely ceding some serious value here — and it's not a coincidence they're all WRs. Curse you, Matt Harmon!

As I said elsewhere, you could reach multiple rounds on several Exodias and still come away a winner. But it's hard to tell exactly when that's the case. So my only advice: print out my overall rankings, follow them closely, and don't take a WR I have ranked below another one still on the board.

Q: “I loved reading your Draft Guide so much, I read it five times! Do you have anything else for me to read?” If you wanted to earn a PhD in fantasy football, or if you wanted to be a more Game Theory Optimal player, I'd implore you to read the following two articles: [Upside Wins Championships](#) from 2021 (or click [here](#) for the TLDR); and [Ryan Heath's Anatomy of a League-Winner](#).

Q: “Is there anything else you didn't get a chance to say in the Draft Guide that it might be helpful for the reader to know?”

Yes!

I would like to remind the reader to read ‘*The Everything Report*’ each week during the season. In this article, Ryan Heath and I will flag must-drop/must-add targets and buy-lows/sell-highs via trade.

On this point, certain players in my Draft Guide are definitely not ‘must-draft players’ for me, but they very well might be ‘must-trade-for in-season targets.’ What do I mean by that? Some players are likely to lose value shortly after your draft before rebounding in the second half — that's a great time to buy them cheap. For instance, I'm expecting Jeremiyah Love's workload to start small and then steadily increase throughout the remainder of the season. Similarly, I love KC Concepcion, but I think there's a really good chance he'll be available off waivers in Week 4. Trevor Lawrence and Drake Maye both have brutal early-season schedules, [as does Brian Thomas Jr.](#) Quinshon Judkins and Cam Skattebo might start the year off slow, coming off of offseason ankle surgery. Etc.

And, conversely, older, injury-prone veterans such as Mike Evans and Davante Adams could be ideal sell-highs once we get to November. Or, Trey McBride, if we're worried about Carson Beck starting in the second half.

This was one of my biggest lessons learned from the 2025 season. I really liked Luther Burden and Colston Loveland last year for their upside in the second half of the season. I feel somewhat vindicated now, looking at their ADP today, but they were basically just dead weight to your roster up until the final month of the season. The same thing happened with TreVeyon Henderson. Although he was very productive in the second half of the season, he also might have been available for free off waivers in Week 7 — meaning he was a wasted draft pick in most leagues. So this year, I tried to keep that in mind when doing rankings, devaluing players who might get significantly cheaper in October. But it's still a delicate balance, because the final four weeks of the fantasy season (the fantasy playoffs) matter exponentially more than the first four, and some leagues are more trade-heavy than others. But YOLO — just know I did the best I could.

Q: “Scott, I’ve graduated from ESPN home leagues and am now doing FFPC high-stakes leagues. How would your strategy change?”

Use [this link](#) or promo code “POINTS” for a free \$25 over at FFPC if you’re a first-time subscriber.

Even before FFPC became one of our sponsors, I’ve been saying for years it’s my favorite site to draft on. I love their scoring settings (TE Premium), and I love their payout structure; a \$350-entry fee will net you \$1,500 if you win your 12-man league and then an additional \$1 million if you finish 1st across the tournament rounds.

Truthfully, your approach shouldn’t look *too much* different from what was outlined throughout the rest of this article (more geared towards home leagues). This is a deep-bench format, so definitely pay more attention to my latest-round values mentioned throughout this piece. And given the \$1M grand prize, I do think you want to be leaning even farther into upside than you would in a typical 12-man home league.

Looking at current ADP (**as of August 19th**)...

Quarterback

On FFPC, scoring is slightly more favorable to pocket passers — 300 passing yards is worth 15 fantasy points instead of 12. With that in mind, the most important thing to remember is that the QB position *really* doesn’t matter. This change slightly impairs the hyper-mobile Exodia-tier QBs, but more than anything, it just increases parity across the board. In all of my FFPC drafts, I want to be one of the last teams to take my first QB. I also have no issue with drafting 3 QBs — the historical hit-rate here is quite good. (You just want to make sure you’re dropping at least one of them by Week 3.) Best values and primary targets are Brock Purdy

(ADP: QB11), Jaxson Dart (QB12), Kyler Murray (QB17), Malik Willis (QB18), Matthew Stafford (QB15), and Baker Mayfield (QB20).

Running Back

I think you'll still like your teams better if you had at least two RBs by the end of Round 3, but that is certainly less of a priority on FFPC, rather than ESPN or Yahoo!.

Josh Jacobs is an Exodia if you can get him at his Round 4 ADP. If not, David Montgomery is always a great fallback plan in Round 5. Grab both if you don't have two RBs by the end of Round 3.

The other Exodia RB is Jadarian Price and **not** Jonathan Brooks. Brooks is a bit too expensive for my liking (ADP: RB29), but on FFPC... **David Caruso rips off his sunglasses**... the price is right on Price (RB26).

(I'm so sorry.)

If you intentionally took more of a Zero-RB approach, or if you're still light on RB at this point (for any reason), there's some really good value in names like Tony Pollard (ADP: RB32) and Jacorey Croskey-Merritt (ADP: RB36). It's definitely a lot grosser after that, but I also like the value in Chuba Hubbard (ADP: RB40) and Aaron Jones (RB44), especially if you feel your RB depth is weak, or don't totally trust your RB2.

Wide Receiver

WRs fly off the board fast in FFPC. There's still a ton of good value later, but I always want three WRs by the end of Round 6.

FFPC ADP moves almost too fast to keep up with — so long as you're drafting off my ranks, you'll do fine. Do that and there's a good chance you end up with:

There's a very good chance you're going to draft Tee Higgins (ADP: WR20) and Mike Evans (ADP: WR27) if you follow my overall rankings. They're both FFPC Exodias.

Parker Washington is more expensive on FFPC (WR29) than anywhere else (WR31-35), but he's still a must-draft Exodia for me.

KC Concepcion is another FFPC Exodia WR, priced as just the WR46.

In the final rounds, I'm frequently throwing a dart at names like Cyrus Allen, Malik Washington, Tank Dell.

Tight End

I've had some killer FFPC teams over the years, and all of my best teams took a quantity-over-quality approach at the TE position, foregoing a top-5 TE, but then immediately loading up at the position.

In every FFPC draft, I want to make sure I get at least one of Harold Fannin Jr. (ADP: TE7, Round 6) or Sam LaPorta (TE8, Round 6). George Kittle is a decent value once again (TE9, Round 7), but not quite as strong as Fannin and LaPorta.

And then I want to draft as many TEs from among the Isaiah Likely (TE10, Round 7), Dallas Goedert (TE13, Round 8), Dalton Kincaid (TE12, Round 8), and Mark Andrews (TE14, Round 9) tier as possible.

Terrance Ferguson is an Exodia on FFPC even if you have to reach multiple rounds (TE21, Round 13). And I also love the value on Greg Dulcich (TE23, Rounds 12-13) and Pat Freiermuth (TE28, Round 16) in the later rounds.

Obviously, you don't want 15 TEs on your team when you only have two flex spots. Try to use common sense here. The more TEs you draft early, the fewer you need in the later rounds.

Kicker / Defense

Whatever. Take them in the last rounds of your draft. You can reach a little bit on DST if there's a team you really like. Just don't reach too far.

Q: "Who are some players worth prioritizing or bumping up in your ranks in keeper leagues?"

In a keeper league, my primary targets would be guys like...

- RB Blake Corum
- WR Malik Nabers
- WR Jordyn Tyson (assuming his price drops, as he's currently hurt)
- WR KC Concepcion
- WR De'Zhaun Stribling
- WR Denzel Boston

Q: "Can you add a change log, so I know what's been changed with the last update?"

Sure!

- **August 6th:** Bunch of updates, mostly breaking ties with Ryan's rankings. (Sorry, I wasn't tracking this, but will do so moving forward.)
- **August 7th:** Added a link to [MattyB's auction tool](#).
- **August 11th:** Ryan Paganetti is scaring me off of Ashton Jeanty a little bit, so I moved him down two spots in my rankings. The Tier 3 of my RB rankings has always felt very tight, anyway. (I'll have Paganetti on School of Scott next week to lay out the argument.)
- **August 18th:** Added a new special section at the top for Auction drafters.
- **August 18th:** Updated ADP throughout, also added separate ADP sections and graphics. Upon request, I replaced ESPN ADP with ESPN RK and Yahoo! ADP with Yahoo! XRNK.
- **August 18th:** Moved some of the Exodias up to keep pace with ADP. Moved Chris Olave way up, Juwan Johnson up, Devaughn Vele up, and Jordyn Tyson down because Tyson just suffered his 4th reinjury since October and is now expected to miss the next two months. Moved Emeka Egbuka down as it appears he may be dealing with turf toe. I moved Ladd McConkey up (finally capitulating to Ryan Heath) — I told him during the debate, the big thing holding me back was how there was no apparent excuse for how bad his 2025 season was. Greg Rosenthal [recently told us](#) he suffered an injury in August and wasn't close to 100% at any point all year, although the team did a good job of keeping it secret. Recorded QB & TE episodes with Brett, and let him break some ties for me. Jaxson Dart gained Exodia-status on Yahoo! where he is QB13... Honestly, there was *a lot* and I'm sure I'm missing some. Sorry for the delay on this.
- **August 19th:** Moved up Nico Collins and Tank Dell to account for Jayden Higgins' season-ending injury.
- **August 21st:** Minor tweaks. Re-worked the "Late Round WR" section. The biggest change was moving De'Zhaun Stribling way up. I still think there's a very good chance he's free off waivers in Week 3, but I am more buying into the hype than not. And it's not hard to see the upside in a Kyle Shanahan offense surrounded by so many injury-prone old (Mike Evans, George Kittle, Christian McCaffrey, and Christian Kirk) / fat (Deebo Samuel) guys.

MORE COMING SOON